IMETAL, C.A. — Generative Engine Visibility Baseline

AI visibility, recommendation and citation audit across ChatGPT, Gemini and Perplexity

Company	**IMETAL, C.A.**
Industry	Industrial and oilfield services (B2B)
Market	Venezuela — eastern region (Anzoátegui)
Measurement date	10 November 2026
Observations	90 (30 prompts × 3 engines)
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Version	1.0

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1. Executive summary

IMETAL appears in **40 of 90 answers** produced by ChatGPT, Gemini and Perplexity when asked Venezuelan oilfield buying questions: **44.4% visibility**.

The headline hides the useful part. The brand shows up when the buyer has already decided to request a quote, and all but disappears while they are still learning:

- **Transactional:** 66.7% visibility.
- **Commercial:** 56.7%.
- **Informational:** 30.0%.
- **Comparative:** 26.7%.

Inside the informational block there is a complete gap: across the **six purely conceptual prompts** — how a major overhaul is performed, what criteria to use when selecting a CNC shop, which pump types require specialised maintenance — IMETAL does not appear **once in 18 observations**.

Three further findings:

1. **Mention is not citation.** 40 answers name the brand, but only **22 (24.4%)** cite `imetal.com.ve` as a source. Without a citation, the mention is reconstructed from memory and may be gone in the next session.
2. **The engines disagree.** ChatGPT mentions the brand in 60% of prompts, Perplexity in 40%, Gemini in 33.3%. Auditing a single engine is not a measurement, it is an anecdote.
3. **Two service lines are invisible.** Drilling-rig logistics: 0 of 9. Compressor maintenance: 0 of 3.

Conclusion: IMETAL competes well at the moment of purchase and loses at the moment of criteria. In AI search that matters more than in classic SEO, because the synthesised answer replaces the first technical conversation with the client.

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2. Scope, and what this report does not cover

This document measures **visibility in generative engines and citation quality**. It is not a full technical SEO audit and not a page-by-page content audit.

Module	Status
Visibility baseline (90 observations)	☑ Completed
Recommendation analysis	☑ Completed and manually validated
Citation and source analysis	☑ Completed
Competitive analysis	☑ Completed with public evidence
Technical SEO audit (crawl, indexing, CWV)	☐ Out of scope — phase 2
Full brand entity audit	◐ Partial — only what the answers reveal
Page-level content audit	◐ Partial — derived from baseline gaps

Declaring this does not weaken the work; it makes it verifiable. A report that promises seven audits and delivers one is weaker than one that delivers one and stands behind it.

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3. Company overview

IMETAL, C.A. — El Tigre, Anzoátegui state, Venezuela. Industrial services company serving the energy and oil sector, with more than 35 years of operation (founded 1990, per its own site).

Declared service lines:

1. **Machining centre (Work Shop):** fabrication and rebuilding of parts and spares for pumps, valves and industrial equipment using CNC technology.
2. **Equipment maintenance:** preventive, corrective and predictive in the field, plus major overhaul in the workshop.
3. **Rotating equipment rebuilding:** centrifugal, reciprocating and screw pumps; centrifugal and reciprocating compressors; rotary heads and electric motors.
4. **Infrastructure:** civil and mechanical construction, piping, tanks and production facilities.
5. **Drilling-rig logistics** (stated in the company profile).

Target buyers: oil operators, joint ventures, drilling and maintenance contractors, and private operators in eastern Venezuela.

Sources: corporate site `imetal.com.ve`; engine responses; public records consulted during the competitive analysis.

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4. Methodology

4.1 Prompt design

30 prompts written as real buying questions, in Spanish, with **no brand name included**. Classified by intent:

Intent	Prompts	What it measures
Informational	10	Discovery: how it works, what criteria to use
Commercial	10	Supplier search: who does it
Comparative	5	Evaluating alternatives
Transactional	5	Contact and quotation

No prompt contained "IMETAL". This is deliberate: we measure whether the brand appears **without being named**, which is the only visibility that brings new clients.

4.2 Execution

Each of the 30 prompts was run once in each engine:

- **ChatGPT** (signed in).

- **Gemini** (signed in, Automatic mode).
- **Perplexity** (signed in).

Critical rule: every prompt ran in a **fresh chat**, with memory off and no prior context. A single chat for all 30 would have carried prompts 1–29 into prompt 30 and invalidated the measurement.

Total: 90 observations.

4.3 Variables recorded

Per observation: prompt, engine, date and time, full response, brand mention, recommendation, cited URLs, competitors detected.

4.4 Metric definitions

Metric	Definition	Denominator
AI Visibility Rate	Answers containing "IMETAL" as a word	90 observations
Recommendation Rate	Answers presenting the company as a suggested option, ranking it, or evaluating it positively	90 observations
Recommendation per mention	Recommendations / mentions	40 mentions
Citation Rate	Answers citing `imetal.com.ve` with a URL	90 observations

On recommendation: all 40 mentions were reviewed one by one. No automatic rule was used. Appearing in a neutral comparison table does not count; being described as "the option that best matches" does. The validation sheet with the textual reason for each case is part of the appendix.

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5. Baseline results

5.1 Overall

Metric	Cases	Denominator	Result
AI Visibility Rate	40	90	**44.4%**
Recommendation Rate	30	90	**33.3%**

Metric	Cases	Denominator	Result
Recommendation per mention	30	40	**75.0%**
Citation Rate	22	90	**24.4%**

75% recommendation per mention is the most favourable figure in the study: when IMETAL appears, it is almost always positioned well. The problem is not how it is described, it is **how often it is chosen** and **at which moment**.

5.2 By engine

Engine	Observations	Mentions	AI Visibility	Recommendations	Rec. Rate	Citations	Citation Rate
ChatGPT	30	18	60.0%	12	40.0%	18	60.0%
Perplexity	30	12	40.0%	10	33.3%	0*	0.0%*
Gemini	30	10	33.3%	8	26.7%	4	13.3%
Total	**90**	**40**	**44.4%**	**30**	**33.3%**	**22**	**24.4%**

* Perplexity does not expose source URLs in its web interface. Its zero does not mean it never cites; it means this method cannot verify it.

Reading: ChatGPT is the most generous engine (60%), but also the most superficial: it includes the brand in broad sweeps and recommends it less often (66.7% of its mentions are recommendations). Perplexity and Gemini mention it less but recommend it almost every time (83.3% and 80% respectively).

5.3 By search intent

Intent	Prompts	Obs.	Mentions	Rate	Citations
Transactional	5	15	10	**66.7%**	5
Commercial	10	30	17	**56.7%**	10
Informational	10	30	9	**30.0%**	5

Intent	Prompts	Obs.	Mentions	Rate	Citations
Comparative	5	15	4	**26.7%**	2

The pattern is monotonic and consistent across engines: **the closer the buyer is to purchasing, the more IMETAL appears**. That is exactly what a website built to convert rather than to explain produces.

5.4 By service line

Line	Obs.	Mentions	Rate
Spare parts fabrication and rebuilding	9	6	**66.7%**
Rotating equipment maintenance	18	10	**55.6%**
Integrated industrial services	9	5	**55.6%**
Pump rebuilding and maintenance	30	15	**50.0%**
CNC machining	6	2	33.3%
Mechanical infrastructure and facilities	3	1	33.3%
General industrial services	3	1	33.3%
Drilling-rig logistics and supplies	9	**0**	**0.0%**
Compressor maintenance	3	**0**	**0.0%**

Spare parts is the strongest line. The two zero lines are also the ones with the least published content and the weakest associated entity presence.

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6. The conceptual gap

Six prompts ask for an explanation, not a vendor list:

1. How is a major overhaul of a centrifugal pump performed?
2. What services does an oil company need to maintain its rotating equipment?

3. What criteria should be used when selecting a CNC machining shop?
4. Which industrial pump types require specialised maintenance in oil operations?
5. What does preventive, corrective and predictive maintenance include?
6. What equipment and services are needed to support drilling-rig logistics?

Result: 0 mentions in 18 observations. Zero verifiable citations.

In these answers the engines explain the process in generic technical language and cite no Venezuelan supplier at all. In other words: **the space is not held by a competitor — it is empty.** Nobody has published the explanation the engines could cite.

The strategic implication is direct. In commercial prompts you compete to appear in a list. In conceptual prompts you compete to **be the source of the explanation**, and today there is no incumbent.

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7. Competitive AI visibility

172 entities were detected across the 90 answers, after normalising variants and excluding IMETAL itself and PDVSA as an operator. Classification was based on public evidence, not proximity in the answer.

7.1 Confirmed direct competitors

Company	Appearances	Evidence
TAMEGCA	6	Talleres Metalmecánicos G, C.A. Anaco, since 1991. 7,000 m², API/ACME threads, oilfield equipment repair. Tax ID J-80315650-5.
GESCA	5	Global Equipment & Services, C.A. (ISESAS Group). Turbomachinery service centre at the José Antonio Anzoátegui petrochemical complex. Turbine, compressor and pump repair, balancing, NDT. Tax ID J-40628867-5.
M&B International	4	Lecherías. Rotating equipment maintenance and EPC since 2008.
MIV Grupo	3	Mecanizados Industriales de Venezuela, C.A., Maracaibo. CNC machining and rotating equipment repair. Tax ID J-29412859-9.
VB Oil & Gas Energy	2	Barcelona. In-house workshop for pump and rotating equipment repair.
FREYM, C.A.	1	Puerto Ordaz. Centrifugal pumps, re-engineering and precision machining.

7.2 Probable direct competitor

Test Pump Venezuela, C.A. — 10 appearances, the most mentioned company in the study. It exists as a registered company with imports from China (import records, 2024), but no corporate site or service catalogue was located. Remains probable until its scope is verified.

7.3 Partial competitors

- **DISTEINSA** (4): pump repair using polymer coatings plus distribution; no CNC machining.
- **Hidrostática de Venezuela** (1): hydraulic vane, piston and gear pumps.
- **Hidranaven** (1): hydraulics and pneumatics.
- **Austral Vibrations & Technologies** (1): condition monitoring and mechanical maintenance.

7.4 Complementary suppliers

PERGAS, COMERINC, Denarius Pumping Services, MAROCA and global operators (Baker Hughes, Halliburton, Weatherford). They do not compete for the same work; they appear in the same answers because buyers treat them as part of one ecosystem.

7.5 Sources, not competitors

`pymesvenezuela.com` (business directory) and the Venezuelan Oil Chamber – Zulia. They are cited as sources, not as supply.

7.6 Competitive reading

No competitor dominates. The most mentioned in the set is Test Pump (10), followed by TAMEGCA (6) and GESCA (5). IMETAL, with 40 mentions of its own, leads on volume — but **its advantage disappears when the prompt is conceptual**, where nobody appears. That is the winnable ground.

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8. Citations and sources

22 of 90 answers (24.4%) cite `imetal.com.ve` with a full URL. The rest mention the brand without supporting it with the domain.

Breakdown:

- **ChatGPT:** 18 citations out of 30 answers (60%). The most link-generous engine and the easiest to audit.
- **Gemini:** 4 verifiable citations, though it labels the domain in more answers through source chips without a full URL.
- **Perplexity:** 0 verifiable, due to its interface limitation.

Why it matters: a mention without a citation is reconstructed from memory. It can change between sessions and it generates no traffic. A citation is evidence that the company's content was retrieved and used. For GEO, the citation is the hard metric; the mention is the soft one.

Third-party domains most frequently cited alongside the brand: `cosapi.com.ve`, `testpumpvenezuela.com`, `mbinter.net`, `gesca.com.ve`, `jlmvenezuela.com`, `sumitorve.com`. These are the sources engines rely on to talk about the sector — and therefore the sites where being present matters.

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9. Brand representation

What the engines say about IMETAL is mutually consistent:

- **Location:** El Tigre, Anzoátegui state. Correct in every case.
- **Age:** "founded 1990", "more than 35 years". Consistent with the site.
- **Specialty:** centrifugal, reciprocating and screw pump rebuilding; CNC machining; major overhaul.
- **Differentiator they repeat:** in-house workshop and machining capability.

No serious factual errors were detected in the descriptions. The weakness is not accuracy, it is coverage: when the brand appears, it is described well.

Identified risk: two engines describe it as a "machinery factory" (Gemini, in C03 and C09, taken from Google Maps). That is an imprecise category that can attract the wrong queries.

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10. Opportunities

#	Opportunity	Evidence	Impact	Effort
1	Publish six technical guides for the conceptual prompts	0/18 mentions	High	Medium
2	Create drilling-rig logistics content	0/9 mentions	High	Medium
3	Create compressor content	0/3 mentions	Medium	Low
4	Strengthen domain citations in Gemini	4/30 citations	Medium	Medium
5	Appear on the domains engines already cite	6 frequent domains	Medium	High
6	Fix the "machinery factory" category	Gemini, 2 cases	Low	Low

#	Opportunity	Evidence	Impact	Effort
7	Increase technical data density (standards, tolerances)	Generic sector answers	Medium	Medium

Priority 1 and 2 are the same decision: publish the explanation that does not exist today. It is the only ground where no competitor stands and where effort translates directly into citations.

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11. Strategic recommendations

Immediate (0–30 days).

Publish the six conceptual guides. Each must answer the full question, with steps, criteria and verifiable data (API/ASME standards, tolerances, lead times). These are not service pages; they are technical documents an engineer would cite.

Medium term (30–90 days).

Dedicated content for drilling-rig logistics and compressors. Both lines have zero visibility and are competing against nothing. Reinforce entity markup (structured data, consistent name and category) to correct the "machinery factory" label.

Long term (90–180 days).

Source work: appear on the six domains engines already cite. That is not solved with on-page SEO; it is solved with relationships, sector directories and content others want to link to.

What I do not recommend: optimising for AI "keywords". They do not exist. What exists is content that answers better than the rest and an entity engines recognise without ambiguity.

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12. 90-day roadmap

Month	Action	KPI
1	6 conceptual guides published	Mentions on informational prompts
1	Structured data and entity consistency	Correct category in Gemini
2	Logistics and compressor content	Mentions in those two lines

Month	Action	KPI
2	Baseline re-run (same method)	AI Visibility variance
3	Source work across 6 domains	Third-party citations
3	Final measurement and comparison	Citation Rate

Methodological note: improvement must not be claimed without a comparable second measurement. The roadmap includes the re-run precisely so that claim becomes possible.

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13. Limitations

1. **Single pass.** Generative engines are not deterministic. This study measures one day, not a trend. Repeating with three passes per prompt is the next methodological step.
2. **Three of four relevant surfaces.** Google AI Overviews / AI Mode is missing, and it concentrates the largest volume of affected search.
3. **Undisclosed models.** ChatGPT, Gemini and Perplexity do not expose the exact model version that answered. Gemini in Automatic mode routes between models depending on the prompt.
4. **Perplexity without URLs.** Its interface does not expose source links without manual interaction, so its Citation Rate is not comparable.
5. **Recommendation validated by hand.** That is a strength of the study, but also a limit: 40 human judgements, not a reproducible algorithm.
6. **Partially verified competitors.** 15 of 172 entities have public evidence. The remaining 156 are long tail, mostly single appearances.

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14. Conclusions

1. **IMETAL has visibility, not authority.** It appears in 44.4% of answers, but only once the buyer already knows what they want. At the moment criteria are formed, it does not exist.
2. **The brand is well described and badly distributed.** No factual errors; absence at the discovery stage.
3. **The winnable ground is empty.** Zero mentions in 18 conceptual observations means no competitor has taken that space. It is a window, not a structural problem.
4. **Citations are the metric that matters.** The 24.4% verified citation rate is the best predictor of whether the company's content is actually being used.

15. Appendices

- **A.** Matrix of the 90 observations (engine, prompt, full response, URLs).
- **B.** Validation sheet for the 40 mentions, with the textual reason for each classification.
- **C.** Inventory of 172 detected entities with classification, evidence and priority.
- **D.** Results by intent and by service line.
- **E.** The 30 prompts with their intent.
- **F.** Competitor classification criteria.

Appendices A–F are contained in the workbook `IMETAL_GEO_Baseline_Ronda2.xlsx`.